

The Pioneer, Bemidji, Minnesota Friday, June 3, 1977

Cliff Morlan's Sports Review

Checked with several resorts yesterday and most sound optimistic about the summer's outlook. Fishing generally is holding up pretty good. Big White is giving up some large walleye catches. Working best seems to be Little Rice, Little Joe Floating Jigs and the Northland Minnesota Rig with nightcrawlers and jumbo sized leeches. Bass dealers in the area are jumping as they try to keep supplied. If you are going to carry minnows very far try the plastic bag with water and oxygen. Phelps red spinners Red Spinners are working good at Red Lake.

Entries are being taken up until Friday, June 10 for Jerry's 2nd annual Lunker contest. June 11, Cost will be \$20 per boat with two fishermen to the boat. Only the first 30 entries will be accepted. Rules and regulations are posted at Jerry's out on Highway 71 south just across the tracks.

Tickets are on sale around Bemidji and area towns for the BSU Scholarship Fund Fishing Contest. June 24-25. The fishing contest will be on the BSU. Lots of drawings for merchandise awards plus a fishing seminar and fish fry put on by the famous Bemidji Fry Crew are included in the \$1.50 fee.

What an exciting finish to the Twin-Yankee game I had the chance to watch Wednesday night. Thursday was a different story as Billy Martin's Yankees bombed the Twins 13-3. The Yankees, led by some fine pitching by Ron Guidry, led the Twins 5-1 going into the last inning. Rod Carew, on a 1-2 pitch and two-out with Jerry Terrell on third base and Butch Wynegar on second, lashed a clutch single for the winning run. Wynegar had played Krukus to start the winning rally. Billy Martin had made one trip to the mound after Krukus singled but decided to stick with Guidry. Terrell singled between Krukus and Wynegar. It appeared that Guidry had struck Wynegar out on a 1-3 inside breaking pitch.

However, umpire Art Francis called it a ball. Then Wynegar singled. Manager Martin started back out to the mound to pull Guidry but veered towards the plate to let Francis know that he thought it was a bad call. Francis must have assumed Billy with some of his hot as Bill started back towards Francis and I thought he was going to belt him. Martin called in his ace reliever Sparky Lyle and he got Butch to ground out. Krukus had played Krukus to start the winning rally. Billy Martin had made one trip to the mound after Krukus singled but decided to stick with Guidry. Terrell singled between Krukus and Wynegar. It appeared that Guidry had struck Wynegar out on a 1-3 inside breaking pitch.

Krukus, the Twins backup first baseman and designated hitter, is one of the most improved players. Gene's Place will send out a charity benefit for Sunday's Jackpot Day at the Met against Boston. Gene has all treats reserved and a few standby fans. Good to see Bemidji represented by a bus load of fans. Gene plans a few more trips this summer as if you interested stop by at 209 Minnesota and register. Charge for the bus ride, ticket to game and some refreshments is only \$11. I can't drive my car down and back for less than \$26.

I'm sure that scribe Jim Wallace of the Brainerd Dispatch will be dropping me a line waiting to know if I'll still trade Carew to Kansas City for John Mayberry, first baseman, and left handed hurler Andy Hassler. Yes, Jim I would. Rod has been in a slump of late but that was a beautiful single he got Wednesday. Mayberry also had a hot night Wednesday when he bashed out three home runs in the 11-3 win over Toronto.

I had a post-game sandwich with Cal Griffith, Angie Giuliani, Bob Allison, Billy and Jimmy Robertson and they were ever elated about the comeback victory. I mentioned that the hit to me was reminiscent of '85 when Harmon Killebrew hit a homer in the last of the 9th to beat the Yankees prior to the All-Star game which was played at the Met that year. Harmon's hit seemed to start the Twins drive which led to the World Series that year. Let's hope Rod's game winning hit does the same thing.

Geoff Zahn kept his record at 6-3 as the Twins rallied behind Tom Johnson for the win. The win set the St. Paul hurler's record at 5-2. Johnson came in in the 9th and struck out catcher Healy. Don grounded out Nettie to Chambliss and Randolph struck out. The crowd of 23,664 fans really gave Carew a standing ovation. It broke a 9-0 slump for Rod. Thursday, 32,008 watched the Yankees 10-3 win.

Visited with veteran writers Bob Beebe and Dick Cullum and they were just as tickled as a person could be with the comeback win. Both are now retired with Cullum writing a Thursday column in the Minneapolis Tribune. I have had a few questions asked of late and I knew they could answer them for me. One lady called and wanted to know who the 'Silver Fox' was that pitched for the Millers then went up to the Giants. It was Jesse Peavy. One party wanted to know who the catcher was back in the Miller days when they had Joe Hauser, Andy Cohen, Abby Wright etc. It was Pinky Hargrave.

Follows along press row were happy when Tom Mee announced on the P-A system that Arno Goethel, the St. Paul Pioneer-Press Dispatch, Sports Editor had a successful operation and the hump he had removed was benign. Sid Hartman told me that one doctor had just told him it was almost a million to one that Goethel would come through. Arno is one of the finest in our business. He told me a few years ago that he and his wife were vacationing here in the area and how proud he was to see how many people were taking the Pioneer. Arno had to explain to her it was the Bemidji Pioneer and not the St. Paul Pioneer. Hope Arno has a complete recovery. Chatted with Bob Bodor who handles the sports write for the UPI which feeds our local radio station KBJM. Bob is a good workman. Gary Libman, the new Tribune Sports Editor, also sat in my area. He is a pretty sharp guy but I'll still rate Jim Cernusca as the best beat writer in the state. Bemidji's youth programs will never get publicity like they are getting now when Jim gets to retirement age—when is a week—Jim's Braves will meet the Lions at a Saturday on the BSU field in exhibition play. Both Carrington and John Melhus have added a few new players to their rosters and want the practice game before starting league play must work.

Two bad our Jacks lost the sub-region game to Thief River Falls 3-1 yesterday. Hope the Prowlers and Bagley do well in the regionals.



Key play
Bemidji staved off trouble momentarily in the sixth inning of the sub-region 4 title game when first baseman Bob Lucas fielded Bruce Williams' bunt and threw out Scott Sabo at third. John Noga takes the throw. Umpire Greg Potvin sets the call. However, Doug Dellmann and Mark Thorstad followed with singles to score two runs, breaking a 1-1 tie and giving the Prowlers a 3-1 victory.

Prowlers beat Bemidji 3-1 to win sub-regional crown

by JIM CARRINGTON
The Thief River Falls Prowlers captured the sub-region 4 baseball title Thursday afternoon, defeating Bemidji 3-1 in a well played game at the BSU stadium.

Prowlers into the Region 3AA tournament at St. Cloud Tuesday where they will face the sub-region 1 winner, probably St. Cloud Tech or Apollo. Apollo ousted Alexandria 5-0 Wednesday. It was a day of wasted opportunities for the Prowlers. Manager Martin started back out to the mound to pull Guidry but veered towards the plate to let Francis know that he thought it was a bad call. Francis must have assumed Billy with some of his hot as Bill started back towards Francis and I thought he was going to belt him. Martin called in his ace reliever Sparky Lyle and he got Butch to ground out. Krukus had played Krukus to start the winning rally. Billy Martin had made one trip to the mound after Krukus singled but decided to stick with Guidry. Terrell singled between Krukus and Wynegar. It appeared that Guidry had struck Wynegar out on a 1-3 inside breaking pitch.

Over the next four frames, Miller allowed just two base runners and both were erased on the bases. Terry Dyrval singled to open the second but was picked off first. Thorstad pointed a life on an error in the fourth. But when Dickson homered to third Thorstad tried to take third on the play and was cut down on Bob Lucas throw to Chambers to complete a double play.

Bemidji, meanwhile, was putting on runners and leaving Bemidji. Two walks around Mark Ehardt's single loaded the bases in the second but Bemidji failed to get the timing. Rick Nelson singled to the fourth and reached third on a sacrifice and Larry Elchmidt's single hit Chambers (first) in center for the third out.

Elchmidt to end that inning. The Jacks went down in order in the seventh.

The Prowlers won in the last of the sixth, Scott Sabo, the ninth pitcher, walked and Miller hit Brad Kiesel with a pitch. Chambers was able to relieve and held off trouble momentarily as Lucas fielded Williams' bunt to force Sabo at third.

But Dellmann hit the first pitch through the right side to score Kiesel and Thorstad singled to left to score Williams. Chambers got the next two but the damage had been done.

Dallmann was the only player with two hits. The win lifted Thief River's record to 2-4 going into regional play. Bemidji closed its year at 8-10, its first losing record since 1959.

Seven seniors closed out their careers. Lucas, Moonshine, Miller, Nelson, Elchmidt, Kiesel and Mike Orpin. Returning regulars include Chambers, Miller and Brad Orpin who will be bolstered by this year's reserves and graduates of a 193 B team.

Weaver mistake proves costly as Orioles fall

By KEN RAPPOPORT
AP Sports Writer
The Baltimore Orioles have been playing nearly flawless baseball of late, but the same hasn't held true for their manager. He has made two errors in the last two weeks.

"The only explanation I have is maybe I'm thinking too far ahead," said Earl Weaver.

Weaver, who admittedly committed a tactical blunder off cost Baltimore's recent game against Minnesota, made another strategic mistake Thursday night as the Orioles dropped a 7-4 decision to the Chicago White Sox.

"It was all my fault," it was all my mistake," said Weaver.

"That's why I held a meeting and apologized to my players. I told them we're still in first place and if we keep playing like we have we'll stay in first place."

With the bases loaded in the third inning, the Orioles had right-hander Tony Chavez pitching with right-handed batter Jim Easton coming to the plate for the White Sox. At 0-2 pitch, Weaver misjudged the ball for left-hander Scott McGregor.

Left-handed pitcher against right-handed batter? "For some ungodly reason," said Weaver. "I thought first base was open for McGregor. Well, Easton intentionally got to Ralph Gar. After I motioned for the pitching change, I realized my mistake."

Everyone else in the bullpen realized Weaver's mistake with Easton. A bases clearing double, clearing the White Sox with a 7-4 lead and their eventual winning run.

In other American League games, the New York Yankees routed the Minnesota Twins 10-3, the Detroit Tigers beat the Baltimore Orioles have been playing nearly flawless baseball of late, but the same hasn't held true for their manager. He has made two errors in the last two weeks.

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Reds blow late lead, lose to Astros in 11

CINCINNATI (AP) — For eight innings, the Cincinnati Reds couldn't do anything wrong. Then they couldn't do anything right.

Jack Billingham lost his stuff in the ninth, blew the Reds' late lead in the top of the 11th, the Reds came back with a run in the bottom of the 11th on singles by George Foster, Dave Concepcion and Dan Driessen.

But Watson then felled Cincinnati's hard grounders down the first base line, tagged out Driessen before he ran and stopped on the base for a game-ending double play.

The loss dropped the Reds to 10-10 in the National League West. The Astros won 11-10 in the bottom of the 11th on singles by George Foster, Dave Concepcion and Dan Driessen.

The Astros won in the 11th with a three-run rally highlighted by Art Howe's two-run double off Dale Murray. In the only other National League game Thursday night, the New York Mets defeated the Montreal Expos 7-4.

Lee Mazzilli drove in three runs with a two-run homer and a sacrifice fly as New York downed Montreal and handed the Expos their 18th defeat in 23 games.

"I've got a lot of things to learn and I'm not going to learn them overnight," said the 21-year-old Mazzilli, the youngest regular in the Mets' lineup. "Manager (Joe Torre) said to me it's just a matter of time. He feels I can be a .300 hitter."

Hishman went over the left field wall after John Stearns had walked leading off the second inning against the Cincinnati Reds. "Just don't understand," said Dan Warthen.

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